MONTHLY UPDATE

Botswana: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Strategies, plans and policies

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity · Data Storage · Energy

DPI
Data Exchange · Digital Payments and Fintech · Other GovTech and e-Gov

TECHNOLOGY
AI

DATA
National statistics

GEOPOLITICS
China activities

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

NATIONAL DATA STRATEGY

- **Botswana concludes capacity building and stakeholder engagement for national data strategy** — Digital Watch Observatory, 14 September 2026

  Five-day data governance training of 7-11 September 2026 feeds Botswana's National Data Strategy drafting.

SMARTBOTS DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION STRATEGY

- **Govt targets UNEP to build smart economy** — DailyNews (Botswana Press Agency), 23 September 2026

  Formal SmartBots launch set for November 2026; Boko asks UNECA's Gatete to stay on as flagship partner.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

BOFINET INTERNATIONAL CAPACITY LEASE THROUGH SOUTH AFRICA

- **BoFiNet upgrades its available international capacity to 1 Tbit/s** — Connecting Africa, 23 September 2026

  Botswana Fibre Networks signed a long-term international capacity lease with an unnamed South African partner, raising capacity through the Ramatlabama and Pioneer Gate border crossings from 300 Gbit/s to 1 Tbit/s.

DIGITAL DELTA IX

- **BoFiNet launches Digital Delta IXP** — ITWeb Africa, 6 October 2026

  Botswana's state fibre operator BoFiNet announced the launch of the Digital Delta Internet Exchange Point, where service providers, mobile operators and content and cloud providers can exchange local traffic inside the country. It builds on the operator's Tier III-certified data centre.

UNIVERSAL FUND BROADBAND EXPANSION ALONG THE TRANS-KALAHARI HIGHWAY

- **Botswana invests in highway connectivity** — ITWeb Africa, 12 October 2026

  Botswana's universal service fund, working with one mobile operator, has deployed 12 mobile broadband and voice sites along the 1,900km Trans-Kalahari Highway at a cost of P34.5 million, the communications minister said. Infrastructure sharing with the other two operators is to extend coverage by the end of the next financial year.

Data Storage

KALA DATA CENTRE

- **Tlou weighs Kala data centre expansion** — ITWeb Africa, 5 October 2026

  Tlou Energy's annual report says Botswana's gas-powered Kala Data Centre ran well below its design of about 1MW in the year to June 2026, for lack of gas from the one connected well. The company has begun planning a pipeline from a second well, and any expansion depends on gas supply and funding.

Energy

ELECTRICITY TARIFF APPLICATION 2026-27

- **BPC 2026-27 Electricity Tariff Application — Consultation Paper** — Botswana Energy Regulatory Authority (BERA), 15 December 2025

  BPC's own case for a 46% tariff rise — P9.585bn revenue requirement, P3.477bn funding gap.

KALA HYBRID GAS AND SOLAR GENERATION

- **Tlou weighs Kala data centre expansion** — ITWeb Africa, 5 October 2026

  Summarised under Data Storage.

DPI

Data Exchange

NATIONAL ELECTRONIC KNOW-YOUR-CUSTOMER PROJECT

- **Botswana launches national eKYC project to make bank verification easier** — Business Tech Africa, 11 September 2026

  Banks to verify identities against the national citizen database; the source states no launch date.

Digital Payments and Fintech

FNBB EWALLET TRANSFERS INTO MOBILE-MONEY WALLETS

- **FNBB muscles into mobile money race** — Mmegi, 14 September 2026

  eWallet to open transfers into Orange Money, MyZaka and Smega; FY2026 pre-tax profit P2.12bn, up 12%.

GOOGLE PAY ON ABSA BANK BOTSWANA CARDS

- **Absa Botswana's Google Pay, Bringing contactless payments to a nation still reaching for them** — Weekend Post, 21 September 2026

  Absa Bank Botswana has made Google Pay available on Android for its Visa debit, credit and multi-currency virtual cards, with no extra fees. The launch date was not given. The service only works where merchants have NFC terminals, and the report says these are patchy outside Gaborone and Francistown.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

ROAD TRANSPORT AND SAFETY LICENSING SYSTEMS

- **The system is down, not the road traffic act** — Sunday Standard, 5 October 2026

  Ministry press release of 29 Sept 2026: permits stamped by hand, manual roadworthiness receipts until systems return.

Technology

AI

AI CLINICAL DECISION SUPPORT THROUGH THE BOTSWANA-UPENN PARTNERSHIP

- **OpenEvidence and Penn Medicine partner to extend AI clinical decision support to Botswana** — YourBotswana, 18 September 2026

  Announced 15 Sep 2026; tools to be co-built with Botswana-UPenn Partnership clinicians; no Botswana timetable.

Data

National statistics

GAMBLING PARTICIPATION STATISTICS

- **Weaving the Slip** — Botswana Gazette, 2 September 2026

  Betting influencers, family mobile wallets, and a country that keeps no gambling statistics.

Geopolitics

China activities

CHINA-BOTSWANA COMPREHENSIVE STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP JOINT STATEMENT

- **中华人民共和国和博茨瓦纳共和国关于建立全面战略合作伙伴关系的联合声明** — Embassy of the People's Republic of China in Tanzania (republishing the China-Botswana joint statement), 13 October 2026

  China and Botswana raised relations to a comprehensive strategic partnership in a joint statement issued during President Duma Boko's state visit. It affirms digital sovereignty and each state's right to choose its own path on artificial intelligence; Botswana joins China's digital economy trade-cooperation initiative and will consider joining the World AI Cooperation Organization.

HUAWEI COOPERATION AGREEMENT ON DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

- **Huawei critical partner in digital transformation** — Botswana Daily News (BOPA), 14 October 2026

  Signed 13 Oct 2026 in Beijing on Boko state visit: cloud, smart education, telemedicine, AI public security; no sum.

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